

relative resemblance between the two figures was very soon noticed, and led to a somewhat modified conception of Satan. The latter has become exactly like Anro-mainyus in the Chronicler (third century, B.C.), who renders the older account, that *Jahveh* incited David to number the people,* in these words: "And *Satan* stood up against Israel and provoked David to number Israel."† This shows that the conception of the moral world had undergone an important change. The older Israelitish prophets and prophetic historians had not hesitated to derive even evil, moral evil not excepted, from *Jahveh*:‡ the belief that *Jahveh* directed all things was so strong in them, that they did not recoil from this consequence. Even the second *Isaiah*—perhaps with an eye to, but yet at variance with, the Persian dualism with which he was acquainted—had put these words into *Jahveh*'s mouth:

"I form the light and create darkness,
I make peace and create evil,
I, *Jahveh*, do all these things."§

But it is not unnatural that objections to this conception should have arisen in the minds of some: *Jahveh*'s moral purity seemed to them to be not uninjured by being thus made the immediate cause of sin. The remedy was at hand. Anro-mainyus was not unknown to the Jews and—*Satan* stood ready as it were to undertake his part.

When the first step upon this road had once been taken, men gradually went further. In the book of *Tobit*—an ethic romance, perhaps from the first century before our era, to which we shall revert hereafter—another wicked spirit, *Aehsma-daeva*, called here *Asmodeus*, is introduced as taking an active part.|| About the same time we find a number of wicked spirits mentioned in the revelation of *Enoch*, and among them, it would seem, some of Parsee origin.¶ We know from the New Testament how wide an influence the popular belief of the Jews ascribed to "demons."

* 2 Sam. xxiv. 1.

† 1 Chron. xxi. 1.

‡ Comp. Vol. I. p. 48.

§ Isa. xlv. 7.

|| Chap. iii. 8; vi. 15, seq.

¶ Kap. 6, seq. (ed. Dillmann).